7.1 A ship-specific contingency action plan based on specific triggers from monitoring of biofouling parameters should be described in the BFMP.

7.2 As presented in figure 1, monitoring of hull/fuel performance during ship operation should identify whether there may be an increased risk of biofouling accumulation.

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
biofouling parameters should be described in the BFMP.

7.2 As presented in figure 1, monitoring of hull/fuel performance during ship operation should identify whether there may be an increased risk of biofouling accumulation. When monitoring identifies a possible increase in biofouling accumulation, the ship is at a higher risk level which should lead to contingency actions. A contingency action plan may involve inspection of submerged surfaces in line with chapter 8.

7.3 A contingency action plan may include measures which are ship-specific and relevant for the monitoring parameters. In general, a contingency action plan could include the following aspects:

.1 proactive actions can be implemented to lower the risk of biofouling accumulation if a higher biofouling risk may be predicted owing to planned operational changes;

.2 corrective actions to operating profile, maintenance or other repair plans, if the monitoring identifies an early indication of elevated risk; and

RESOLUTION MEPC.378(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
2023 GUIDELINES FOR THE CONTROL AND MANAGEMENT OF SHIPS' BIOFOULING TO

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
monitoring identifies an early indication of elevated risk; and

RESOLUTION MEPC.378(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023)
2023 GUIDELINES FOR THE CONTROL AND MANAGEMENT OF SHIPS' BIOFOULING TO MINIMIZE THE TRANSFER OF INVASIVE AQUATIC SPECIESMEPC 80/17/Add.1
Annex 17, page 14

I:\MEPC\80\MEPC 80-17-Add.1.docx
.3 inspection may be necessary to determine biofouling accumulation if the monitoring of biofouling parameters identifies an indication of prolonged elevated risk. The inspection should be in line with chapter 8.

7.4 Depending on the relevant biofouling risk parameters, the contingency action plan should trigger a reaction to be conducted in line with the BFMP.

7.5 If an inspection is conducted and biofouling is identified, cleaning actions should be conducted as described in table 1.

7.6 Monitoring of risk parameters may also identify and trigger a need for maintenance of MGPS or AFC.

8 INSPECTION

8.1 Inspections should be carried out:

.1 by organizations, crew or personnel competent to undertake inspections following these guidelines and competent to use relevant inspection methods

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
MGPS or AFC.

8 INSPECTION

8.1 Inspections should be carried out:

.1 by organizations, crew or personnel competent to undertake inspections following these guidelines and competent to use relevant inspection methods or equipment to determine the level of biofouling and the condition of the AFS;

.2 for the purpose of fixed schedule inspections, by inspection organizations or personnel able to provide impartial inspection; and

.3 for the purpose of inspections as part of contingency actions, by organizations, crew or personnel competent for such inspections.

8.2 The fixed schedule of inspections should be carried out in line with the minimum frequencies as described in paragraphs 8.4 to 8.6.

8.3 Inspection frequency or inspection dates (or date ranges) for in -water inspections during the in -service period of the ship should be based on the ship -specific biofouling risk profile (see appendix 1), including inspection as a contingency action, and specified in the BFMP. The BFMP should also specify management actions to be taken when biofouling is identified during inspections (e.g. cleaning), including changes to inspection frequency.

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
BFMP. The BFMP should also specify management actions to be taken when biofouling is identified during inspections (e.g. cleaning), including changes to inspection frequency.

8.4 For ships not undertaking performance monitoring, the first inspection date should be within 12 months of application, reapplication, installation or renewal of AFS to confirm their effective operation.

8.5 Where monitoring indicates that the AFS is not performing effectively soon after application, reapplication, installation or renewal (e.g. increased fuel consumption), an inspection should be carried out to confirm the condition of the AFS and level of biofouling as soon as practical or possible, in line with the BFMP and contingency action plan. If adequate performance of the AFS is observed through monitoring, the inspection could be conducted up

to 18 months after application, reapplication, installa tion or renewal, noting that such monitoring may not reflect the level of biofouling in all niche areas.

8.6 Subsequent inspections should occur at least every 12 to 18 months and may need to increase to confirm the continued effectiveness of ageing or damaged AFS. In -water

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
monitoring may not reflect the level of biofouling in all niche areas.

8.6 Subsequent inspections should occur at least every 12 to 18 months and may need to increase to confirm the continued effectiveness of ageing or damaged AFS. In -water inspections should seek to coincide with existing subsea operations (e.g. underwater inspections in lieu of dry -dock or any other in -water inspections), including any unscheduled subsea operations. If no AFS are installed in areas of a ship and no other measures are undertaken such as in -water cleaning or propeller polishing, then inspections should occur more frequently (<12 months) to manage the risk of biofouling accumulation.

8.7 In-water inspections should assess biofouling across the entirety of a ship's hull and niche areas. If high levels of biofouling are identified during an inspection and there are reasons

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
Annex 17, page 15

I:\MEPC\80\MEPC 80-17-Add.1.docx
8.7 In-water inspections should assess biofouling across the entirety of a ship's hull and niche areas. If high levels of biofouling are identified during an inspection and there are reasons to suspect issues with the AFSs effectiveness, actions should be taken to manage the biofouling and subsequent inspections should occur more frequently, for example biannually until dry-docking and recoating of AFC.

8.8 In-water inspections should determine the level of biofouling of the hull and niche areas and the condition of the AFS. The inspection areas should be subdivided into appropriate sections as listed in tables 4 and 5 of appendix 2. The fouling rating for each area on the ship should be the highest rating identified in the inspected areas.

8.9 The following should be investigated during the inspection:

.1 rating of the type and approximate extent of biofouling in line with the definitions in table 1 below;

.2 condition of the AFC on the hull and in niche areas as described in paragraph 8.7 using definitions in table 4; and

.3 functionality of the MGPS in niche areas.

---CHUNK---

SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
definitions in table 1 below;

.2 condition of the AFC on the hull and in niche areas as described in paragraph 8.7 using definitions in table 4; and

.3 functionality of the MGPS in niche areas.

Extent of biofouling and recommended actions

8.10 During an inspection, niche areas in the ship -specific BFMP should be inspected as a priority. All inspected areas should be allocated a fouling rating number in line with the extent of fouling as defined in table 1 below.